

knowing whether the e-mail was opened. Such instances would include legal and important business issues. Keep in mind that opened doesn't mean read, and that the recipient can decline an RR request so you will not be notified.

9. Understand that you will be on a continual learning curve. All of us are. The online world is changing constantly. The only constant is change! If you do not have the desire to learn and do not make the effort to understand the 'culture' of the technology in which you are participating, you will not be taken seriously by your fellow Netizens. You also may get terse e-mails from other Netizens pointing such issues out to you—some may not be as nice as others. Do not fire back at them! Use such situations as an opportunity to learn what you are doing wrong so you do not anger others.
10. If you receive a nasty e-mail, do not respond immediately—if at all. People are bold and overly critical on the other side of this screen. They tend to not hesitate to point out what they think you need improvement on while not bothering to notice the good or positive points on the very same issue.

Many times, these people are simply trying to get a rise out of you (this is called trolling) or are trying to make themselves feel self-important. Many times, they're just jerks. If you do not have something nice or constructive to say, or at the very least sternly professional—just hit 'Delete'.

11. Keep in mind that all private e-mail is considered to be copyrighted by the author. If you post private e-mail to a public list or board, or forward it to an outside party in whole or in part, you must include the author's permission to post the material publicly. Not doing so can get you into trouble legally or with your friends and associates.
12. Always compress or 'zip' large files before sending. Many people who are new to the online world do not realise how large